Argument in Favor of Measure Q

Measure Q. Qualifications Over Politics.

Vote YES on Measure Q to ensure Fairfield's City Clerk is selected for qualifications, experience, and professional competence—**NOT campaign politics.**

The City Clerk is the keeper of Fairfield's public record. Every agenda, ordinance, resolution, meeting minute, public notice, election filing, campaign disclosure, and official City action depends on the Clerk's Office being accurate, impartial, transparent, and professionally managed.

This is not a policymaking position. The City Clerk does not set taxes, approve development, adopt budgets, or make laws. The Clerk administers elections, maintains public records, protects access to government information, and ensures official actions are properly noticed, recorded, preserved, and available to the public.

Today, these responsibilities require **specialized knowledge of election law,** the Brown Act, the Public Records Act, the Political Reform Act, conflict-of-interest rules, records retention, agenda procedures, cybersecurity, and modern information systems.

Yet an elected candidate generally needs **NO professional certification,** relevant experience, or specialized training.

Measure Q would allow Fairfield to recruit broadly and select **the best-qualified** professional based on:

- Education
- Experience
- Integrity
- Management ability
- Knowledge of elections, records, and open-government laws

Measure Q also strengthens accountability.

An appointed City Clerk can be evaluated regularly, held to **clear performance standards,** and replaced if the office is not meeting Fairfield's expectations. Voters will continue electing the City Council—the officials who make policy and **remain directly accountable to the public.**

More than two-thirds of California cities already appoint their city clerks because this work has become technical, demanding, and essential to honest, effective government.

Measure Q does not weaken transparency. **It protects transparency b**y placing this important office in the hands of a qualified, neutral professional accountable for results.

For professionalism, accountability, public access, and good government, vote YES on Measure Q. **Fairfield deserves nothing less from this vital public office.**

s/ Karen L Reese
City Clerk

s/ Kevin O'Rrourke
Retired City Manager